

application and want to quickly jot down some related information, for taking quick notes when on a phone or writing down your thoughts when reviewing some document.

There are two ways to quickly launch the Side Note window. Clicking on the OneNote icon in the system tray pops the Side Note window. Alternatively, pressing the combination of [Windows] + [N] has the same results.

Tables

Presenting data in tabular form has its own advantages and OneNote offers it too. Importantly, tables can be made using just the keyboard. Pressing TAB after any word creates a cell,

Car	Model	Engine Capacity	Price
Ferrari	F430	4.5 Ltrs	\$89000
Lamborghini	LP650	6 Ltrs	\$50000
Porsche	Carrera	5 Ltrs	\$35000
Maruti	SW4	2 Ltrs	\$7000

Use TAB and ENTER to create tables, it's that easy!

pressing [Tab] again creates another, this way you can create an entire row consisting of data. On pressing [Enter], the cursor moves to the second line creating the second row of cells. To jump between cells [Tab] can be used. [Ctrl] + [Enter] + [E] or [R] can be used to insert a Row to the left or right of the cursor, [Ctrl] + [Enter] to insert a row below, and [Alt] + [Enter] to add one more line inside a cell.

Calculator

Need to do a basic arithmetic calculation when taking down notes? Well, OneNote can help you do that too. Let's say, if you want to calculate 570 divided by 20, then just write down $570/20=$ and press [Spacebar]. The "=" sign is important, once you have written it simple press [Spacebar] and the

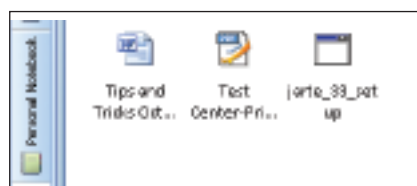
Mathematical Functions	
1.	$570/20 = 28.5$
2.	$\sin(30) = 0.5$
3.	$\cos(60) = 0.5$
4.	$\sqrt{25} \times 8 = 40$

OneNote 2007 loves math, even Algebra!

answer will be calculated automatically. Even Complex mathematics such as $\sin(30)$ and Squareroot functions can also be derived.

Attaching Files To Notes

OneNote allows storing of documents and other files directly on a page. This comes handy when you want to organise all your project related material in one place. You can add files in two ways. First, click on Insert >



Drag and drop files to directly attach them to your OneNote page

Files, and in the browser box which opens, select the files to add. The less geeky way of doing it is by dragging the required document and dropping it on to the OneNote page.

Full Page View

During brainstorming sessions, when you are taking down lots of notes expanding the view to full screen comes handy. In OneNote the Full Page View button placed next to Help menu is one way of doing it, or you can simply press [F11].

POWERPOINT

Those in marketing can't live without it, your friends often spam you with an offspring containing a corny message, and most presentations depend on it. The beauty of PowerPoint is that it can be used for both personal and professional use, so if you have to present your ideas at a sales meet, your college, or want to irritate your friends with your philosophies on tree-hugging, keep reading...

Minimise The Ribbon

For those who want more Desktop area to work with, the ribbon might get



Hide the Ribbon to liberate screen space

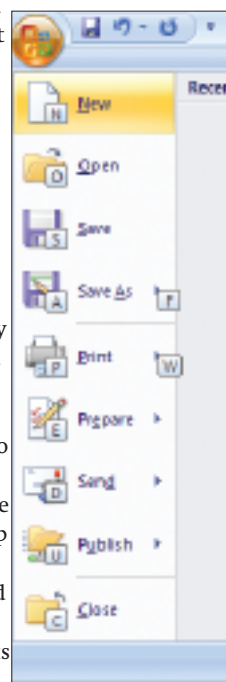
in the way. This is especially true for those working on resolutions of 1024x768 or lower — Office 2007 seems to demand higher resolutions. In order to minimize the Ribbon, just right-click on any of the tab names and select "Minimize the Ribbon". Now you will be able to see all the names of the tabs, but not all the buttons. When you need to do some formatting or changes, just click on the name of a tab and all the buttons will return in all their glory. A single click means that the ribbon will auto-hide, and a double-click will keep it there permanently.

Customise The Quick Access Bar

Next to the Office logo you can find the quick access toolbar. By default, this has a shortcut to Save, Undo and Redo, which is a little pointless, because we're all quite adept at using the respective keyboard shortcuts. However, each of us may have some task that we perform regularly, which have difficult to remember keyboard shortcuts, or complicated ones requiring key-combinations. In such cases, it would be useful to customize the quick access toolbar. Just right-click on the toolbar and select "Customise Quick Access Toolbar". Now choose the shortcuts you want to display on the Quick Access toolbar, and click OK.

Easy Keyboard Shortcuts

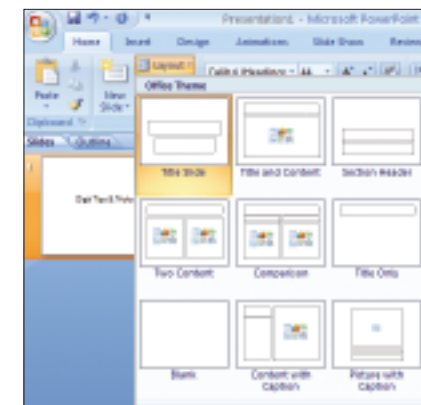
For keyboard warriors, the most irritating thing about the new PowerPoint is the fact that a few shortcuts have changed. What most people don't realize is that Office 2007 has shortcuts for every single menu item, which previous versions did not, and they're easy to identify as well, thanks to the little letters that pop up when you press [Alt]. It is a good idea to learn the keyboard shortcuts if you spend a sig-



nificant amount of time using any Office application, using [Alt] and the cues (called Key Tips) provided; it couldn't be simpler! Most of the older [Ctrl] + [Some key] shortcuts are left unchanged, so you really will not find yourself too frustrated!

New Slide Layouts

By default, a lot of us just tend to add new slides in PowerPoint, without bothering about the slide layout. We then proceed to change the layout and



Choose the correct layout for impressive looking slides

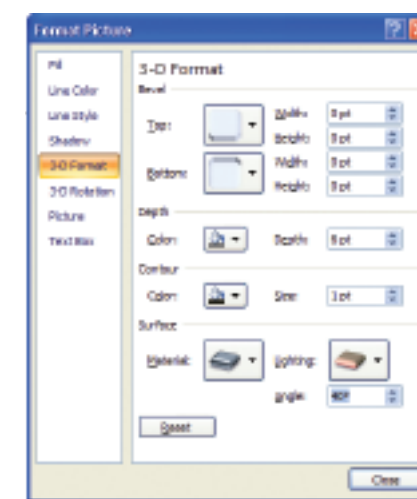
other options. Instead of just clicking on the New Slide icon, click on the text below it and select the layout of the slide even before you add it. This saves you immense amounts of time and energy. For professionals at work, who need to create presentations with hundreds of slides, this is a great boon.

Content Placeholders

When you add a new slide which has blank content placeholders, you will see that PowerPoint 2007 offers little icons in the middle that act as shortcuts to particular types of content. These icons symbolize adding table, chart, SmartArt graphic, picture, Clip Art, media files or plain text. While creating slides, it's likely that you know what it is you're looking to include in a particular place holder, so just click on the associated icon and you can browse through only those types of files on your computer. This will save you hours in the long run.

Adding Effects

When you add a picture or element into a slide, it could appear



3D effects can be added at a mouse-click; presets are available too

rather plain. To jazz it up a bit, take a look at the default picture styles available in PowerPoint 2007. One of these is guaranteed to attract your attention. Besides, if you find one that's close to what you want, but not quite it, you can always select it and play around with the 3D settings to modify the style to your liking. To do this, just go to Format > Picture Effects > Presets > 3D Options and then play around with all the different effects to get the ideal 3D layout for your picture.

Do The Same For Text

As simple as the header above is, it's the truth. You can add all the same effects, if not more, to your text as you did for your pictures. Apart from the standard Word Art selections, you can also apply similar 3D effects to your text. If you insert the text in the same placeholder as the picture, you can apply 3D effects globally, to both the text and the picture at the same time. This works especially well when you want to add a caption to a picture that you have applied 3D effects to — you don't want your presentation looking lame with a cool 3D picture and a standard 2D caption, now do you?

Animations

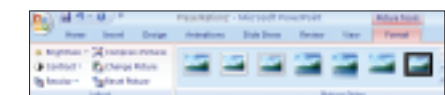
To animate your slides, you have the Animations tab which puts everything in plain sight and within easy reach. From within the Animations tab, look for the Custom Animations button ([Alt] + [A] + [C]). This will open up a Custom Animations

pane on the right, from where you can add animations to individual contents on your slide, instead of animating the entire slide itself. Once you have added your effects, you can just drag them about to reorder them, which makes storyboarding your slide very easy. Also remember to play your animation, using the little play button at the bottom of the Custom Animations pane, to check progress.

In this same pane, you can set various parameters for the animation, including the event (time delay or on click), directions and speed. Every effect in that pane also has a drop down arrow, which will reveal further options.

Formatting Images

Previous Office versions would let you do some changes to the images in your presentations but in a rather non-interactive manner. The new PowerPoint 2007 shows you live previews after every change is made.



Click on an image and click the Format tab that appears in the ribbon. You get a wide range of settings such as Picture Styles, Brightness, Contrast and Color parameters. Move your mouse over any of the styles and the preview will be shown on the image in the slide itself.

Disable Image Compression

By default, PowerPoint 2007 compresses images put into a presentation while saving. While this saves file size, it can result in a loss of quality — which you may not always want.

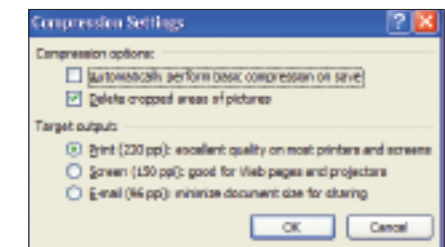


Image compression saves space, but if you have large hard drive you may turn it off.

To disable compression, go to the Office button > Save As. Go to Tools > Compress Pictures. Click on the Options button. Uncheck the